Organizational drivers are situations, or the state of your business environment, in which the nature of the organization itself becomes a bottleneck. Implementing a data mesh should help remove these by shaking up the organizational structures and culture.

SOCIO-TECHNICAL COMPLEXITY

A socio-technically complex organization owns numerous systems producing and consuming data. These systems have been developed by multiple teams, units, or individuals belonging to different chains of command.

Socio-technically complex organizations could also have a few, but enormous, teams struggling with internal communication (for example, not colocated and without a good remote work culture). We believe that socio-technical complexity along with complex data needs are the main reasons to implement a data mesh.

KEY POINT A data mesh is for socio-technically complex organizations with complex data needs.

DATA MATURITY

For data maturity classification, we find the Gartner Analytics Ascendancy Model handy (www.gartner.com/en/documents/1964015). This model describes four stages of data maturity:

1. *Descriptive*—We record what already happened.
2. *Diagnostic*—We know why it happened.
3. *Predictive*—We predict what will happen.
4. *Prescriptive*—We know what we should do to take advantage of what will happen.

A company introducing a data mesh should at least be scorable using this scale (i.e., it should have data collection, storage systems, and culture, thus enabling reliable access to historical data). If this is not the case, the company should start gradually learning how to use available data rather